

INDIA PICTURE

The Judge's Court, Pragpur (Kangra)

Located in the foothills of Kangra valley, The Judge's Court is a historic country manor house dating to the early 1900s. Beautifully restored to maintain the ambience of a bygone era, the hotel offers 30 well-appointed and individually decorated rooms spread over three structures in the orchard complex of the estate. The dining room serves a mix of Indian, Continental and Himachali cuisine, while the Whiskey Priest Bar offers libations of all kinds. Visit the charming heritage village of Pragpur to admire its mud-plastered and slate-roofed houses, cobbled streets and the ornamental village tank. Other activities include visiting local artisans, bird-watching and day trips to Dharamshala and its Norbulingka Institute, which is dedicated to preservation of the Tibetan arts.

Doubles from ₹13,500; judgescourt.com





Chapslee, Shimla

In the erstwhile summer capital of the Raj, Chapslee is a charming heritage building that's just a short walk from Mall Road. Built in 1830, and owned by the family of the former king of Kapurthala, the home was turned into a small heritage hotel in 1976. Since then, it's been known for 'The Chapslee Experience'—warm, personalised service and preservation of traditions like silver service, sit-down meals and high tea. Decked out in chintz, silver and crystal, each of the five suites is uniquely designed and full of bygone charm. While a summer holiday at Chapslee is wonderful, Christmas is particularly special with a traditional dinner; keep your fingers crossed for snow.

Doubles from ₹16,500; chapslee.co.in

